RAFAEL MORETTI-KLEIN

Backend Engineer | Python

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Backend engineer with 21 years of experience in Python, Go and C++, building distributed services and fleet telematics software. Experience includes GPS data ingestion, high-volume APIs, PostgreSQL and cloud deployment on GCP. Currently focused on returning to hands-on individual contributor work; recent coding has centred on Python internal tooling and cost dashboard scripts.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages and frameworks: Python, FastAPI, Django, Flask, Tornado, asyncio, Go, C++

Databases and messaging: PostgreSQL/PostGIS, Cassandra, Redis, Kafka, RabbitMQ

Cloud and infrastructure: GCP (GKE, Pub/Sub, BigQuery), Kubernetes, Terraform, AWS (EC2, S3; limited experience)

Observability and APIs: Prometheus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry, gRPC, Protobuf

Other: Distributed systems design, architecture reviews, automated testing, technical hiring, people management

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Director of Engineering, Platform | Streamhaus GmbH | 2019–Aug 2026

- Led the platform organisation of 45 engineers across five teams, responsible for identity, playback API, billing integration and developer platform.
- Drove a strangler-fig migration from a Python 2 monolith to approximately 60 Python 3 and Go services on GKE. Playback API availability improved from 99.5% to 99.95%.
- Set up a service template using FastAPI or Go, OpenTelemetry tracing, Prometheus metrics and Terraform modules.
- Built an internal cost dashboard using BigQuery billing exports and Looker Studio. Rightsizing and committed-use discounts reduced cloud spend by 31%, or EUR 4.2M per year.
- Introduced an RFC process, architecture review board and on-call guidelines adopted company-wide.
- Grew the organisation from 18 to 45 engineers and conducted more than 200 interviews.

Principal Engineer | Streamhaus GmbH | 2015–2019

- Led technical development of the playback API using Python, Tornado, an internal framework, Cassandra and Redis.
- Designed and wrote most of a Go entitlement service determining playback eligibility by subscription, region and device. It handled 120,000 requests per second at peak with p99 latency under 15 ms.
- Used Cassandra and local in-memory caching for the entitlement service; its technology stack also included gRPC, Redis and Kubernetes.
- Co-authored the company's service template and Python style guide.

Senior Software Engineer | Nordfels Telematik AG | 2010–2015

- Built backend software for fleet telematics, ingesting GPS data from 300,000 vehicles using C++, Python, PostgreSQL/PostGIS and RabbitMQ.
- Led a team of six developers on the route-history product.
- Co-invented a granted German patent for adaptive GPS sampling to reduce vehicle-fleet data volume, 2013.

Software Engineer | Dataquelle Systems GmbH | 2005–2010

- Developed industrial data acquisition software in C++ and Python on Linux and embedded x86.
- Built a Python test harness used by QA for eight years.

OPEN-SOURCE EXPERIENCE

Maintainer, Python retry library | 2012–2018

- Maintained a small Python library using pytest and tox; the project gained approximately 1,500 GitHub stars. Handed over maintenance in 2018.

EDUCATION

Dipl.-Inf. in Computer Science, equivalent to MSc | Rhine Valley University | 2005

LANGUAGES

German and Italian: native | English: fluent

PUBLICATIONS AND TALKS

- "Running Python at 100k rps" — conference talk, 2018
- "Cost is a feature" — internal platform engineering summit keynote, 2023